

school. And you can't bring the party home with you. On the bright side, you're going to be less distracted.

If you answered B, remember that dorm rooms mean minimal kitchen facilities and a lot of takeout, which could amp up the overhead, not to mention the poundage. Keep one eye on the wallet and the other on the scale.

If you answered C, get a breakdown of finances in writing. Roommate situations are fraught with money issues. In fact, it's about the only thing I remember fighting over during my college years: who pays for what and who owes money to whom.

If you answered D, I'm sorry, but you need to listen very carefully to Uncle Kevin. I'm concerned. Yes, the idea of splurging on an awesome apartment during college is tempting, but consider how little time you'll actually spend there. In fact, if you're taking out a hefty loan, this is the wrong place to spend the majority of your cash. Learning to live with roommates and to compromise are key skills that will come in handy in later years. Save your money and bunk up. It's only for a few years.

5. To keep spending under control during your college years, your plan is to:

- a) live like a pauper, make friends with ramen noodles, wash your clothes in the sink, and eat as many meals as possible at home.
- b) budget like crazy, never buying on credit, keeping an eye on every cost, saying no to every extra, and buying used books only.
- c) relegate student loans and any money set aside for school-related items only, using income from part-time jobs to pay for any extras, and pooling resources with other friends for meals and entertaining.
- d) hang around the wealthiest people you can find so they'll pick up the tab. And splurge on ski trips and bar nights. You're not just getting educated, you're creating memories to last a lifetime, right? Aren't they also part of the postsecondary experience?